

5 Foundation Movements

Coaching cues for each pattern | Lisa McPherson, CPT

These five patterns are the backbone of the 4-Week Training Foundations program. Master the cues below and every exercise in the course will feel like a natural extension of what you already know.

01 The Hip Hinge

HIP-DOMINANT

The single most important movement you will learn. Power comes from your hips, not your lower back.

KEY CUES

- > Push the wall behind you with your hips — forces the hinge naturally.
- > Soft bend in the knees, not a squat.
- > Pack your shoulders before you move.
- > Keep the weight close — drag it up your legs.

Watch: if your lower back rounds at the bottom, the weight is too heavy.

02 The Squat

KNEE-DOMINANT

Start with the goblet squat. The counterbalance keeps the torso upright and teaches what proper position feels like.

KEY CUES

- > Knees track over your second toe — follow the feet, don't cave inward.
 - > Chest up, proud posture.
 - > Sit between your heels, not behind them.
 - > Spread the floor with your feet.
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03 The Push

HORIZONTAL PRESS

Poor pressing mechanics build up quietly until they become a real shoulder problem. Get it right early.

KEY CUES

- > Elbows at 45 degrees — not tucked all in, not flared straight out.
 - > Shoulder blades together and down before you lower.
 - > Drive feet into the floor.
 - > Control the descent — 2 to 3 seconds down.
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04 The Pull

UPPER-BODY ROW

Most people press far more than they pull. A strong back directly protects your spine.

KEY CUES

- > Pull elbows to your back pockets — activates lats, stops the shrug.
 - > Shoulders down before you pull.
 - > Squeeze fully at the top of every rep.
 - > Control the return — lower slowly.
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05 The Brace & Carry

CORE STABILITY

Your core's real job is to resist movement, not create it. Crunches miss the point.

KEY CUES

- > 360-degree brace — breathe in and create pressure all the way around.
- > Ribs down — stops the lower back from overarching.
- > Tall spine — string pulling the crown of your head up.
- > Brace before you move, not halfway through.

Day A: Lower Body Strength

Glutes · Legs · Core | 45–60 min | 3 days/week program

WARM-UP — 10 MIN

90/90 Hip Mobility Stretch	8–10 reps per side
Cat-Cow	10 reps
World's Greatest Stretch	5 reps per side
Glute Bridge (Activation)	1 × 15 reps
Lateral Band Walk	15 steps each direction
Leg Swing Front to Back	10 reps per side
Lateral Lunge	8 reps per side

MAIN WORKOUT

Hip Thrust drive through heels, squeeze at the top	3 × 10–12
Romanian Deadlift hips back, keep the weight close	3 × 10
Reverse Lunge front knee over toes	3 × 10/side
Goblet Squat chest up, sit between your heels	3 × 10
Dead Bug lower back flat to the floor	3 × 8/side
Farmer's Carry tall spine, braced core	2 × 20–30 m

COOL-DOWN — 5 MIN

Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch	30 sec per side
90/90 Hamstring Stretch	30 sec per side
Figure 4 Stretch	30 sec per side
Child's Pose	30 sec

DAY B Upper Body Strength Pressing · Pulling · Posture <i>Full course only</i>	DAY C Integration & Core Stability · Movement Quality <i>Full course only</i>
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